

Area of Study 1 – Vocal Music

The pieces selected as set works provide a variety of vocal works from this area of study. These range from a Baroque Bach Cantata, as a sacred work designed for church performance, to *On Wenlock Edge* by Vaughan Williams, a 20th-century work providing breadth to the study of vocal works.

Appendix 4 provides a background and context to the set works. As a complement to the sacred Bach Cantata, there is an extract an Oratorio, *Messiah* by Handel. The Schubert and Mendelssohn lieder are examples of Romantic forms of writing for solo voice that provide background for comparisons to the vocal settings in *On Wenlock Edge*. Romantic operas by Wagner and Verdi show developments in this genre from the Classical operas of Mozart.